



表达观点和立场的作文

Positional Argument

破题练习



段落基本结构



主题句的写法



段落发展策略



段落间的逻辑与过渡



破题练习





One-subject essay:

Damage to the environment is an *inevitable consequence* of the improvement of the living standard. Do you agree or disagree?

*The consumersitic lifestyle **gives rise** to waste of natural resources.*

*Energy production **is directly responsible for** air-pollution.*

*Excessive use of cleaning chemicals **incurs** water-pollution.*

*The **turbo-charged** technological advances bring hope for our environmental future.*

*G o v e r n m e n t endeavours are also proved effective to **minimize adverse effects** on environment.*

*Public education campaigns will **bring about sea-changes** in the present situation.*



Damage to the environment is an *inevitable consequence* of the improvement of the living standard. Do you agree or disagree?

Para 2: To some extent, it is reasonable to argue that the *augmentation* in our *quality of life* *brings* environmental issues *in its wake*.

To start with,...

One reason for this is...

In addition,...

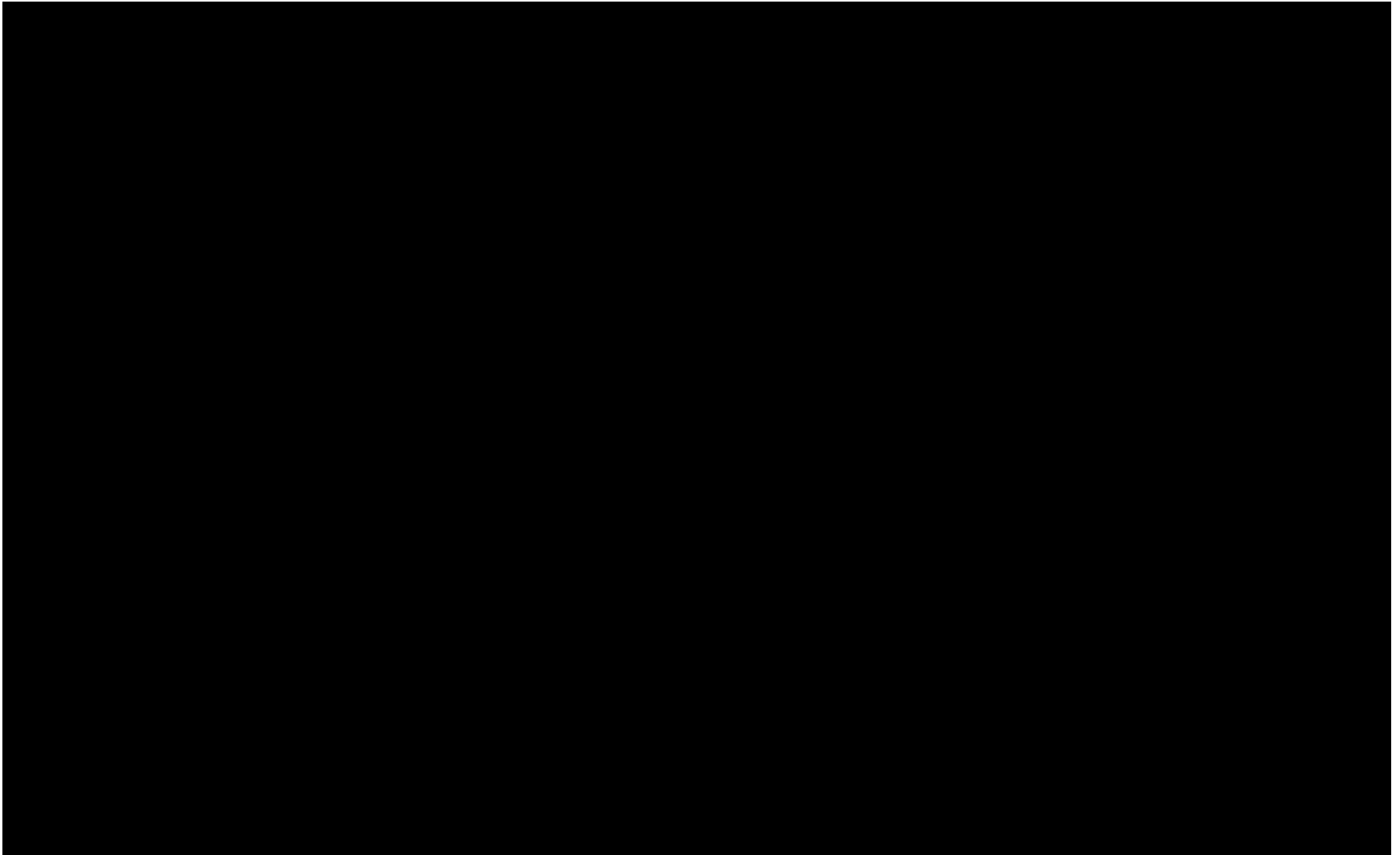
To top it (all) off,...

Another compelling reason is

Para 3: That being said, to say these environmental hazards are *unavoidable* is missing the point.



Five-paragraph Structure



Decide which side to argue:

一面倒

Opening paragraph: *This argument is not convincing.*

First argument: **technological advance**

Second argument: **government endeavours**

Third argument: **public education campaigns**

Closing paragraph: *While it is fair to claim that the growth of our life standards jeopardizes the environment. Efforts from scientists, policy-makers, journalists and educators will make a difference to the situation.*

Decide which side to argue:

水滴式

Opening paragraph: *This argument is not convincing.*

Concession: **Admittedly**, ...does incur environmental problems.

First argument: **However**, technological advances

second argument: **More importantly**, government endeavours

Closing paragraph: *While it is fair to claim that the growth of our life standards jeopardizes the environment. Efforts from scientists, policy-makers, journalists and educators will make a difference to the situation.*



一面倒

Decide which side to argue:

Opening paragraph: *still necessary*

First argument: **communicate more directly and freely**

second argument: **become culture-savvy**

Third argument: **boost intelligence**

Closing paragraph: *While it is fair to claim that machine translation facilitates inter-cultural communication, the benefits children reap from learning a foreign language cannot be overlooked.*



水滴式

Decide which side to argue:

Opening paragraph: *still necessary.*

Concession: **Admittedly**, ...can help people
get
over language barriers

First argument: **However**, communicate more
directly and freely

second argument: **Meanwhile**, become culture-
savvy

*While it is fair to claim that
machine translation facilitates inter-cultural
communication, the benefits children reap from learning
a foreign language cannot be overlooked.*

Closing paragraph:

Decide which side to argue:

驳论式

Opening paragraph: *still necessary.*

Concession: **Admittedly**, ...can help people get

over language barriers

First argument: **However**, machine translation is not reliable, given that the technology is still immature.

second argument: **In contrast**, ...not only able to communicate but also straddle two cultures.

While it is fair to claim that
Closing paragraph: *machine translation facilitates inter-cultural communication, the benefits children reap from learning a foreign language cannot be overlooked.*



Proposal: Physical Education Courses Should Not Be Required

CON (Opposing Side)	PRO (Proposing Side)
<i>1. PE grades unfairly lower the GPAs of some good students</i>	<i>1. Physical fitness is a critical part of education: "A sound mind in a sound body."</i>
<i>2. Students should exercise on their own time, not for credit.</i>	<i>2. Students need an occasional break from lectures, textbook, and exams.</i>
<i>3. One gym course can't turn a poor athlete into a good one.</i>	<i>3. What good is improving your mind if your body is going to pieces?</i>
<i>4. Do parents realize that they are paying for students to bowl and play badminton?</i>	<i>4. PE courses teach some valuable social skills.</i>



Some people think that intelligent children should be taught separately and given special treatment. Others think that students of different abilities should be taught together. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

*the validity of
placement
test*

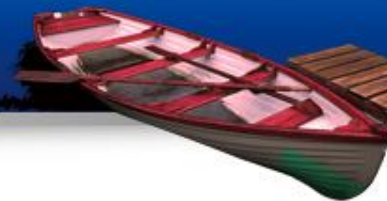
*the sense of
superiority :
Narcissism &
arrogance*

*access to
equal
opportunities*

*education more
specific to
intellectual
levels*

*less sense of
inferiority*

*teachers'
concerns on
progressive
education*

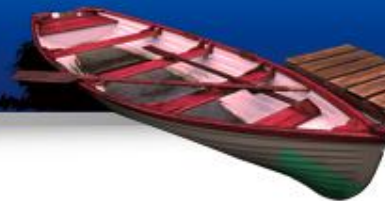


Some people argue that air transport can bring us more choices while others claim it makes industrial and agricultural products cost more. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

<i>higher cost</i>	<i>environmental hazards: energy & emission</i>	<i>food safety: picked , ripened</i>
<i>horticultural-trade: pivot of exports</i>	<i>more market varieties</i>	<i>competition to local farmers</i>



- Some people think **food** has been **changed by technological advances** and this is an improvement while others worry that is harmful. **Discuss both these views and give your own opinion.**



FOOD PRODUCTION		higher productivity, feed the ever-growing global population, less risks of famine, raw materials for biofuel or industries
		fertilizer, poor soil quality, water contamination\ insecticides, kill species\ GM food, tumor
FOOD PROCESSING		better taste, longer shelf-life, more variety
		food additives, carcinogens, food packing, rubbish



- *Nowadays, international tourism is the biggest industry in the world. Some people think the advantages of international tourism outweigh its disadvantages. To what extent do you agree?*

**economic
asset**

**serve to
disseminate
local culture**

**personal
enjoyment**

**environmental
hazards**

**cultural
assimilation**

bother local life



- *More and more women go out to work. It is the responsibility of the government to provide staff and facilities for children of working mother, free of charge. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*



**career
aspirations**

**more financial
ease**

**more labor
force**

massive public
expenses

dual-career
family: children

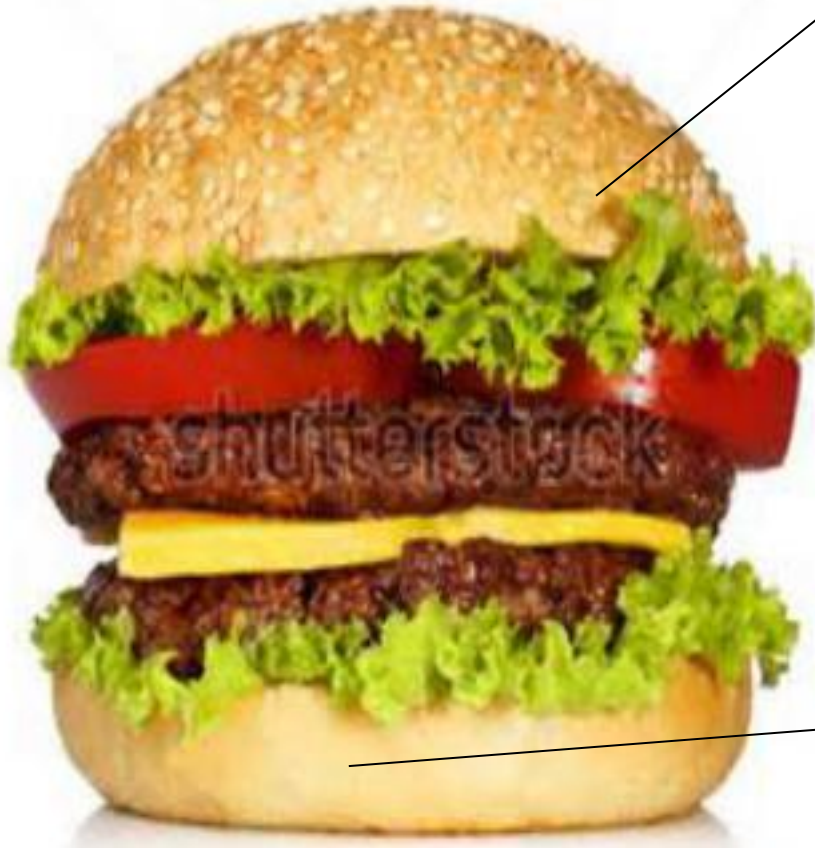
unemployment
figures
hoveringly high

段落基本结构





Topic



Topic sentence: states the main idea of the whole paragraph

*Supporting sentences:
Extend the argument*

May write a conclusive sentence or transitional sentence



*Topic sentence:
brief and to-the-point*

*Supporting sentences:
clear logical progression\
in layers not a whole chunk*

Conclusive sentence:



Paragraph Development

Topic Sentence

Supporting details:

stratification\
explanation\exemplification\
comparison and contrast\facts and
figures
cause and effects\refutation
supposition

Conclusive\ transitional sentence

Paragraph Development



主题句的写法





Topic Sentence

What is a topic sentence?

- *first sentence of a paragraph*
- *the controlling idea of the whole paragraph*
- *consisting of subject and **opinion***
- *being brief and to-the-point*



ancient Egypt, and quickly mac

分层论证



Some other people, however, are strongly against zoos for several sound reasons. **Primarily**, it is morally wrong to take an animal from its home, confine it in unnatural settings and use it for our entertainment. The nature of zoos reflects a worldwide human arrogance towards other species and fosters a disregard for all life. **Furthermore**, overcrowding and unnatural groupings of animals can create stress and lead to severe injury and even death and deaths from aggression, disease, stress and ill treatment are common. **Worst of all**, adults and children visiting zoos will be given the subliminal message that it is OK to use animals for our own ends, though it impinges on their freedom or quality of life; thus zoos will encourage poor treatment of animals more generally.



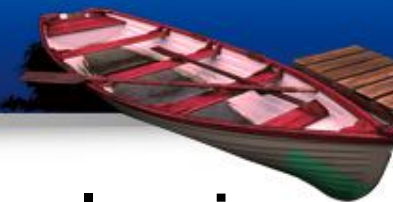
Granted, exams exert adverse effects on students, physically and psychologically. Having to stay up late to prepare for exams, students suffer from extreme lack of sleep which is usually accompanied by ailments like headache, upset stomach and inability to concentrate. In addition, constant waves of stress strike. The expectations from parents, teachers and even students themselves generate crushing tension that can be unbearable even to academic-achievers, let alone those who live in constant fear of not being graduated by schools.



Despite this, the positive roles exams play in education and the selection of talented people should not be overlooked. To students _____

As far as teachers are concerned, _____

On the part of organizations and companies, _____



Despite this, the positive roles exams play in education and the selection of talented people should not be overlooked.

To students, exams **subject them to pressure** and make them **exert themselves** in learning. Without exams, some would idle time away in escapist entertainment.

As far as teachers are concerned, by analyzing exam results, they get feedback of their teaching and are able to **diagnose problems** in students' learning.

On the part of organizations and companies, testing is proved to be a **cost-effective way** of selecting the most competent and talented from a crowd of candidates.



Computers are omnipresent and omnipotent.
(电脑无处不在，无所不能。)

To specify, they are now widely used in all aspects of our life---making digital records in banks; calculating huge amounts of data in science labs; running office documents; helping students look for essay references and enriching our leisure life with games, music and movies.

To put it simple, we cannot live without it.



Compared with attending colleges and universities, distance learning programmes require higher levels of self-discipline on the part of students.



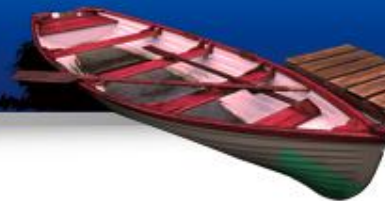
Compared with attending colleges and universities, distance learning programmes require higher levels of self-discipline on the part of students.

To elucidate, when studying at home students are not under any form of supervision. *In other words*, they can goof around, video-chat with friends or play computer games anytime they want.

In stark contrast, universities make students observe codes of conduct and, thus, create a learning-friendly atmosphere which positively influences all students.



Computers can be more intelligent than an average human. A good case in point is Deep Blue, the chess computer. Developed by IBM on May 11, 1997, the machine won the second six-game match against world champion Garry Kasparov by two wins to one with three draws. 阐述: Computers learn by accepting new programs which enable them to know virtually all possible human expertise. In other words, computers have more powerful brains than those of men.



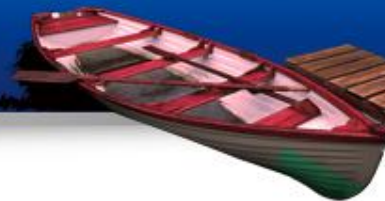
Online courses render it possible for students to get equal access to quality teaching. For example, Coursera, an American online education platform, offers free education to its users. Included in the list of colleges cooperating with it are universities like Harvard, Stanford and Yale which are internationally renowned for their academic excellence.

举例论证



For example, Coursera, an American online education platform, offers free education to its users. Included in the list of colleges cooperating with it are universities like Harvard, Stanford and Yale which are internationally renowned for their academic excellence.

This can be aptly exemplified by Coursera, an American online education platform which offers free education to its users. It collaborates with the worlds' leading universities including Harvard, Stanford and Yale which are internationally renowned for their academic excellence.



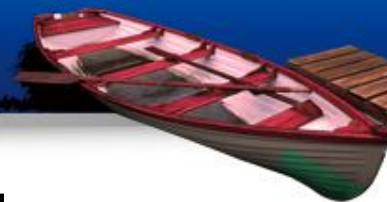
Computers enhance the efficiency of life and work to an extent never heard before.

Before the cyber age, students used to stay for days in the library, thumbing through thousands of pages just to look for one or two paragraphs of essay references. **By comparison**, the same can be done by simply typing a few words in the Google search box and hitting “Enter”.



Unlike internet-based education, colleges and universities provide activities and facilities to support students' learning. A case in point is that _____

In contrast, _____



Unlike internet-based education, colleges and universities provide activities and facilities to support students' learning. **A case in point is that**

students get **hands-on experience** by working in labs and learn how theories **are incorporated with** practices in practical sessions.

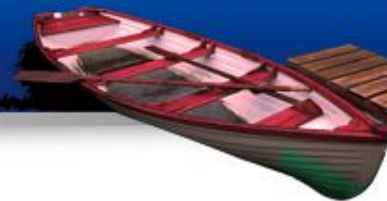
Contrarily, those who study at home can do nothing but merely listen to the lectures, having few chances to engage themselves in active learning by doing things themselves.



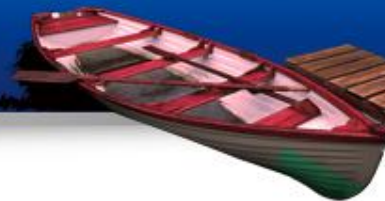
Information can be easily retrieved by the use of computers. As an all-seeing eye and an all-knowing mind, a computer gives answers to questions regarding all topics under the sun. Information ranging from weather forecast and travel tips to stock market indices and research findings is just a click away. Although there is the problem of unauthorized information streaming, stringent measures like copyrights laws are being taken to regulate the behaviors of search-engine providers and information seekers.



The understanding that computers are treasure troves of information can be mistaken. *Granted*, computers present a wealth of information to us. *Nonetheless*, correspondingly, the time we use to browse over this information multiplies. Type any word in the search-box, one will get thousands of results, some of which are just loosely relevant to the key words. Then, much more time is needed to open the pages and check for relevance. The result is often that not much can serve our purpose out of the mass of information.

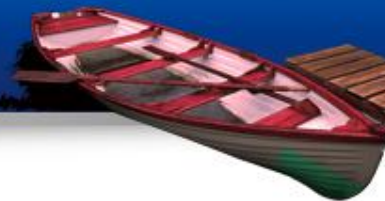


It is falsely believed that e-books are more eco-friendly than traditional paper books. Seemingly, millions of trees are saved by the substitution of printed books with electronic books, which, in turn, helps to relieve the problems of soil erosion and desertification. **The truth, however, is that** other forms of pollution come in the wake of the popularity of e-books. Firstly, the need for batteries, widely acknowledged as polluting, shoots up. Also, as more electricity is consumed when people read e-books on their computers, the problem of air pollution from energy production is intensified.



常见驳论词：

mistaken, false, **unjustifiable**, questionable,
fallacious, unwarranted, erroneous, tenacious,
untenable, **cannot hold water**, **be not**
compelling, be not convincing, be not without
flaws, far-fetched, **be on shaky ground**



段内驳: To begin with, face-to-face teaching which is delivered to a group of students is more communicative than studying online.

To specify _____

Furthermore, _____

虽然不是每个学生都有同等机会参与讨论，很多人在课堂上是沉默的。但是他们从别人的发言里可以获得好处，对话题有更深入的认识。

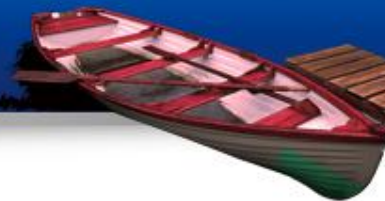


To begin with, face-to-face teaching which is delivered to a group of students is more communicative than studying online.

To specify, students are free to raise any questions to their lecturers during classes or in office hours, which helps them clear doubts.

Furthermore, ample opportunities are given for them to work in teams where they collaborate, discuss and debate with their peer learners.

Although not all students participate and contribute actively to teamwork, they still benefit from others in that they share others' perspectives which **conduces to** in-depth understanding.



Computers break down geospatial distance among people. （电脑打破了人与人之间的地理空间距离）
The virtual world created by computers and cybernetics is an extension of real life. People living online no longer have to go out to accomplish things. **As so**, great convenience can be enjoyed and loads of time can be spared. More significantly, time saved on the way can be devoted to worthier goals.



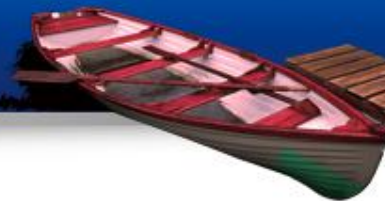
Online courses help to save educational resources.

LOGO



Online courses help to save educational resources.

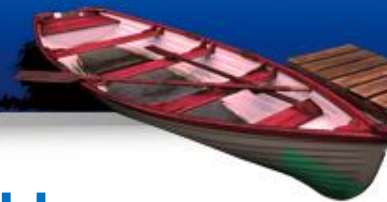
This is because a pre-recorded class can be watched by hundreds, if not thousands, of students at the same time. To universities, this means a great reduction of expenses, **since** they no longer have to employ many teachers to deliver the same content to different classes. Nor do they have to spend massive sums of funds on the construction of teaching buildings and student residences.



Computers bring enrichment to people's leisure time. (电脑丰富了人们的日常生活)。 **Imagine** a day without computers, one can find what boredom means. No games, no music, no chatting with Facebook friends, no blockbusters or TV-shows. When all these choices of pastime are taken away, life can be monotonous.

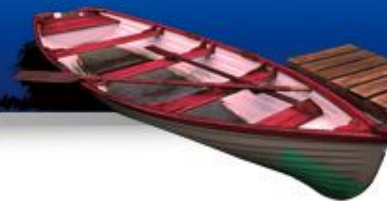


Students who study online are no longer ailed by conflicting time demands. Assume that



Students who study online are no longer ailed by conflicting time demands. Assume that

a student has to attend an interview to do his or her internship in a reputable company. Coincidentally, the interview is arranged at the same time with his or her class. In a classroom-based learning setting, **presumably**, he or she will have to talk to the professor to ask for a leave, which is an embarrassing experience to many. However, internet-based learning offers **such** flexibility of schedules **that** students can easily avoid similar clashes of arrangements.



The wide use of computers can pose potential threats. Over-dependent on computer systems, we are lack of alternative plans in case of a computer technical fault. In some cases, such problem can bring disastrous outcomes. **As reported by ABC news,** a computer glitch in the flight control system caused hundreds of cancellations and flight-delays in just one hour.



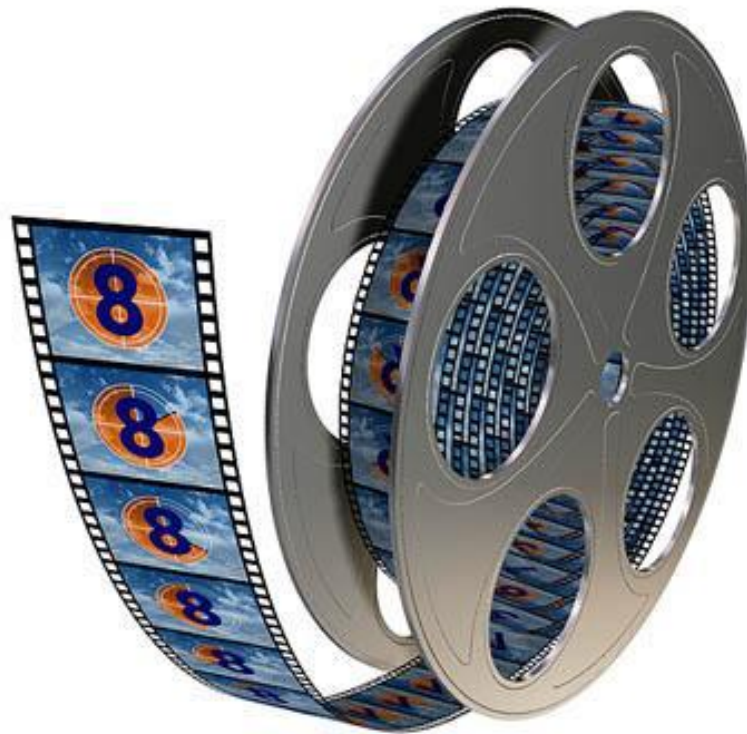
Online education provides opportunities for employed people to further improve their qualifications and , thus, have the edge in job market.

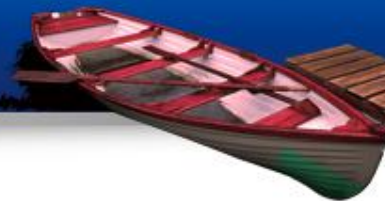


Online education provides opportunities for employed people to further improve their qualifications and , thus, have **the edge** in job market.

As statistics have it, people working in knowledge-intensive industries, such as research, teaching, practice of law, IT and design have to update their skill set every five to seven years to remain competitive in the job market. Otherwise, they are likely to be **edged out**. **With the advent of** online education, classes can be arranged in leisure time. **As such**, they no longer have to leave their workplaces to improve their qualifications.

Transition





Ex 1: 指出下列段落拓展的问题:

Children raised in needy families have stronger self-control as their parents are too poor to give presents to them. They have learned from their childhood experience that things do not come easily and constantly. They have to save money for expensive things they want to buy. When they become adults, they will be more patient and can wait for months or even years before their needs are satisfied. In my opinion, self-discipline is an essential quality for us to succeed.

1. 段落间缺乏连接词
2. 句型单一 (they)
3. 最后一个总结句偏题 for us to succeed

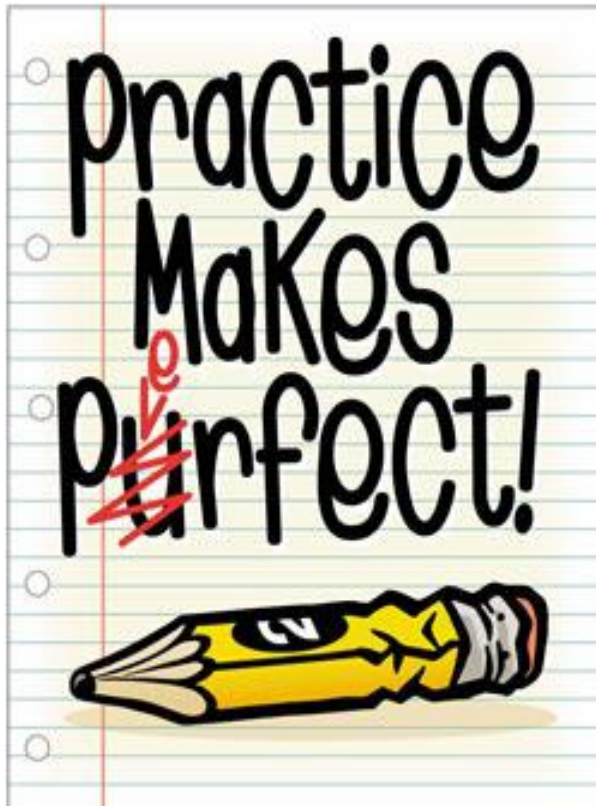


Children raised in needy families usually demonstrate stronger self-restraint than those from affluent backgrounds. Experiences of surviving on meager incomes teach them not to take things for granted. *In other words*, they have to learn how to suppress desires and give up luxuries for essential items. *As a consequence*, odds are that when they become adults, they will be more patient and can wait for months or even years before their needs are satisfied. Self-restraint, as is often the case, is an essential quality for one to cope with situations in adult life.

Sample Analyses

Children raised in needy families usually demonstrate stronger **self-restraint**. *Experiences of surviving on meager incomes teach them not to take things for granted. Instead,* they have to learn how to suppress desires and give up luxuries for essential items. **On this account**, odds are that when they become adults, they will be more patient and can wait for months or even years before their needs are satisfied. Self-restraint, **in my observation**, is an essential quality **underlying** success.

10-minute writing exercise



Time Allowed: 10 minutes

Requirements:

1. Find the argument in the topic sentence.
2. Develop the topic sentence into a paragraph of roughly 70 words
3. Make transitions between sentences.

